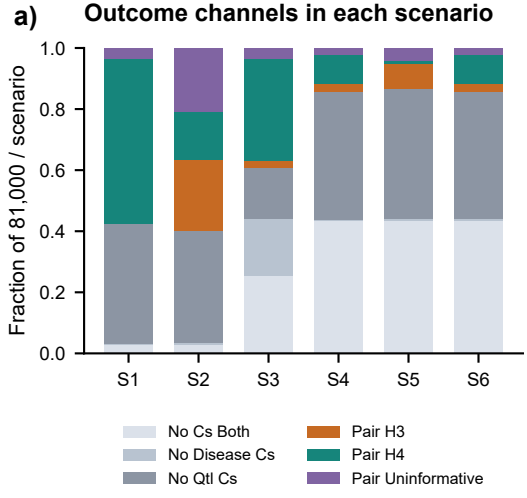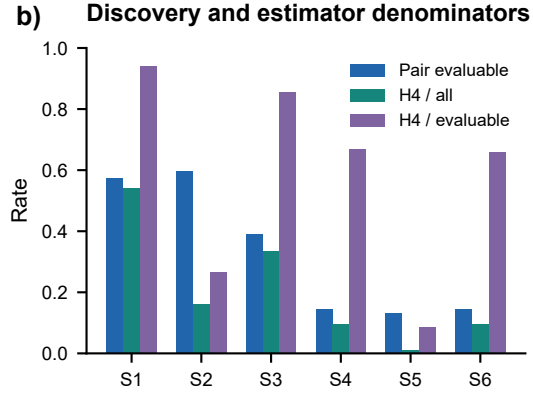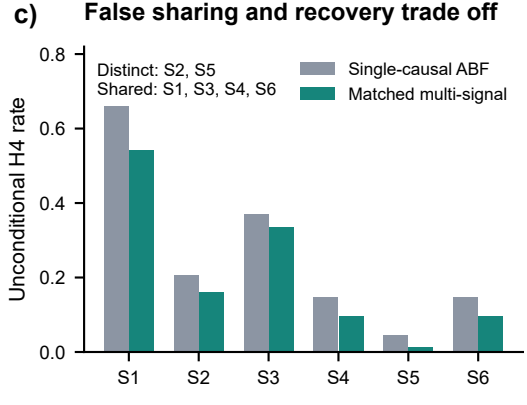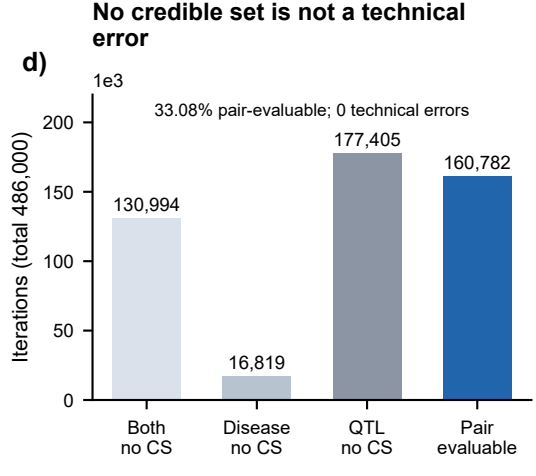Simulation separates discovery from shared-signal decisions